

Connecting ChatGPT to Backstory MCP



September 23, 2026 · James McDaniel

Why connect

ChatGPT only knows what you paste into it or what it learned in training. It can't see what's actually happening in your deals. Once Backstory is connected, ChatGPT can:

- Look up any account and pull its status, open opportunities, and scorecards
- Summarize recent activity and show who's engaged on a deal
- Answer SalesAI questions and find comparable past deals with Situation Search

Reps ask ChatGPT about a deal and get an answer built on real activity data.

At a glance

Server URL	https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp
Authentication	OAuth 2.0, dynamic discovery
What you configure by hand	Just the URL. No client IDs, secrets, or scopes.
Who signs in	Each user, with their own Backstory login. Data is scoped to what the user can see in Backstory.

How auth works Backstory MCP uses OAuth 2.0 with dynamic discovery. ChatGPT reads the authorization endpoints from the server itself, so there are no client IDs, secrets, or scopes to configure by hand. You sign in once and the app stays connected until you disconnect it.

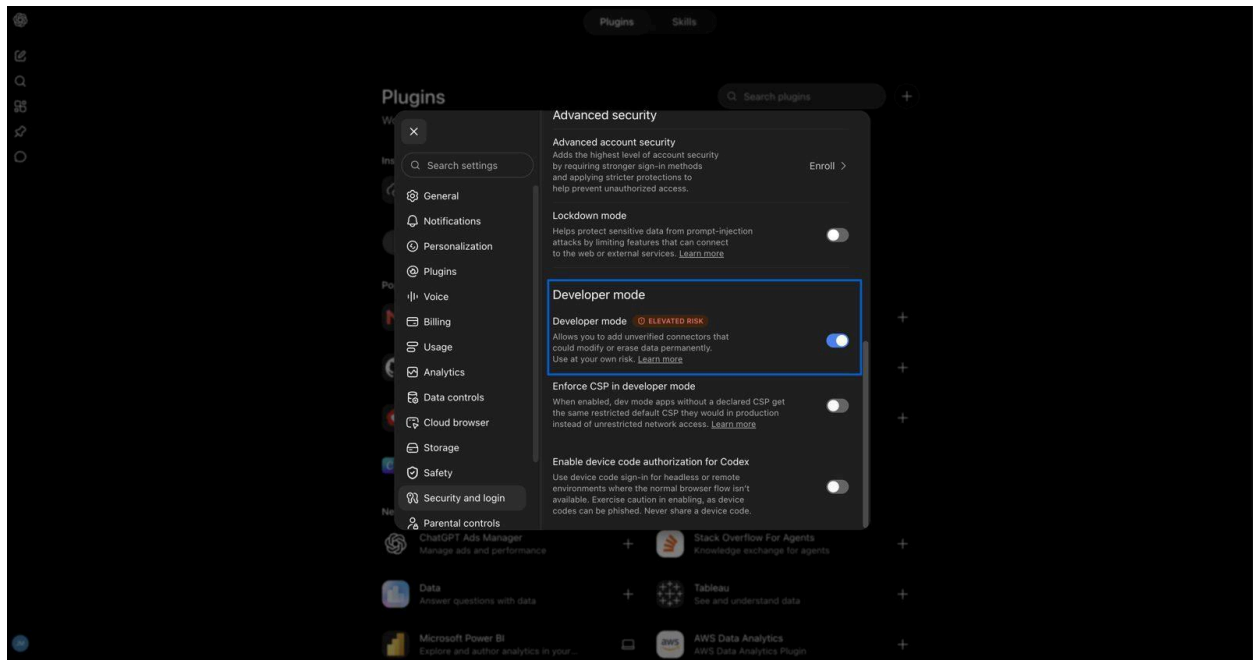
Before you start

- A ChatGPT account on a paid plan that can use Developer mode (Plus or higher). Business and Enterprise workspaces may need an admin to allow custom apps.
- Your Backstory sign-in: your email and your company identification. The connection authenticates as you, so ChatGPT sees only the data your Backstory user can see.
- The MCP server URL below — the only value you have to paste.

MCP server URL <https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp>

1. Turn on Developer mode

Custom MCP apps only appear once Developer mode is on. Open **Settings** → **Security and login**, scroll to **Developer mode**, and switch the toggle on. Leave **Enforce CSP in developer mode** and **Enable device code authorization for Codex** off; neither is needed here.

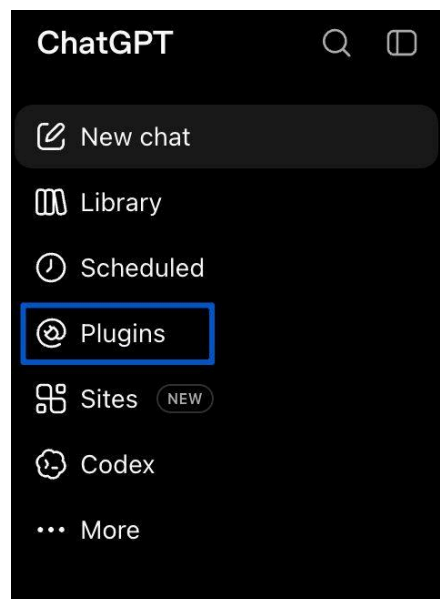


Settings → Security and login → Developer mode

Elevated risk label ChatGPT flags Developer mode because it allows unverified connectors. Backstory MCP is read-only, so it can't modify or erase data, but the warning applies to anything else you add while the toggle is on.

2. Open Plugins

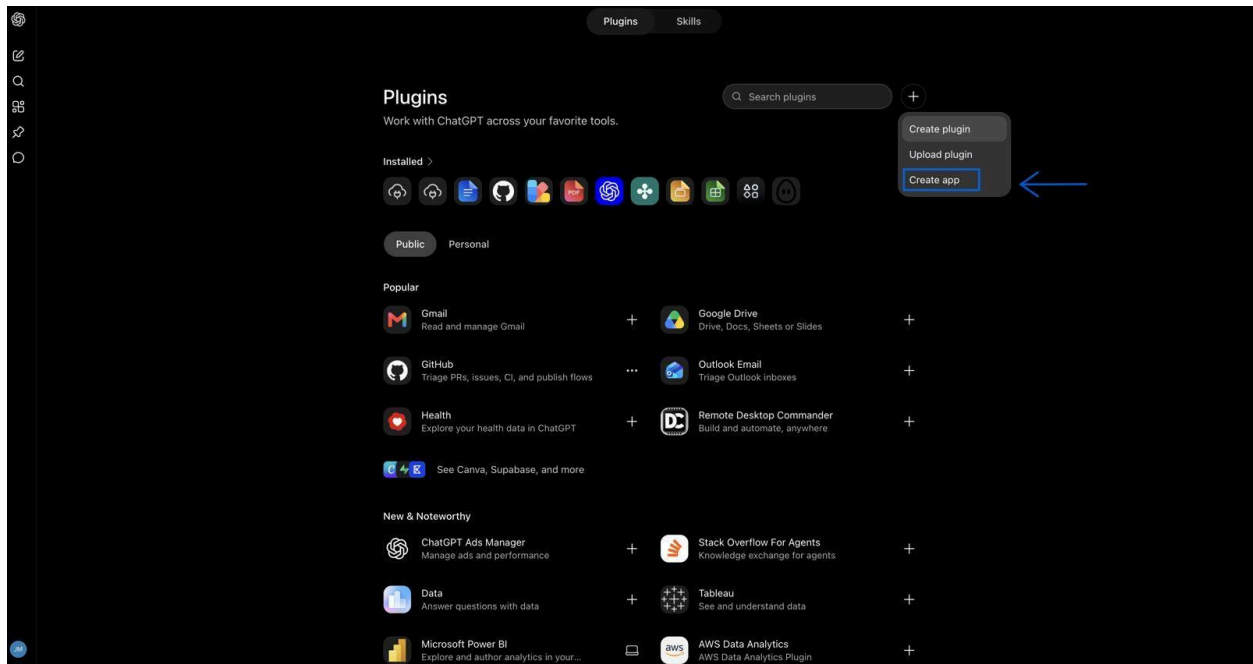
Close Settings and select **Plugins** in the left sidebar. This page replaced the old Apps & Connectors screen, so older guides that point to Settings → Connectors are out of date.



Sidebar → Plugins

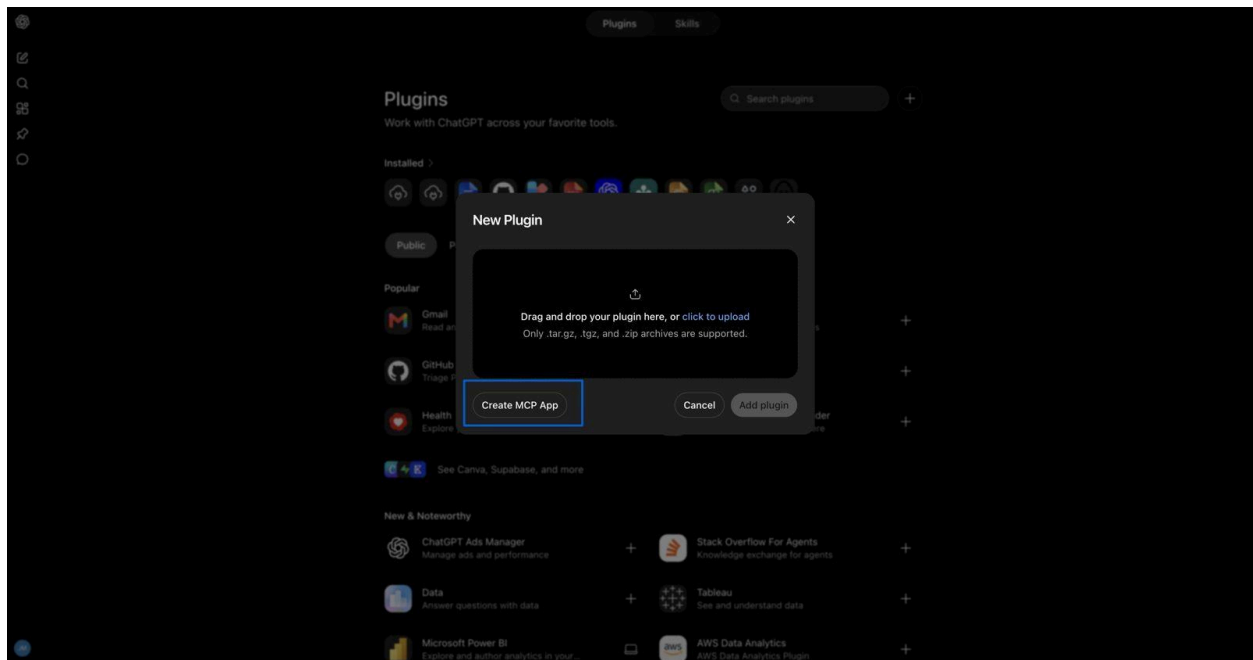
3. Start a new MCP app

Select the **+** to the right of **Search plugins**, then choose **Create app**. Skip **Create plugin** and **Upload plugin**; those are for packaged plugin archives, not a remote MCP server.



Plugins → + → Create app

Landed on a New Plugin instead? If you picked **Create plugin**, the New Plugin dialog asks for a .tar.gz or .zip archive. Don't upload anything; select **Create MCP App** in the bottom-left corner to reach the same form.



New Plugin → Create MCP App

4. Enter the server details

Fill in the new app form, then select **Create**:

Field	Value
Name	Backstory MCP

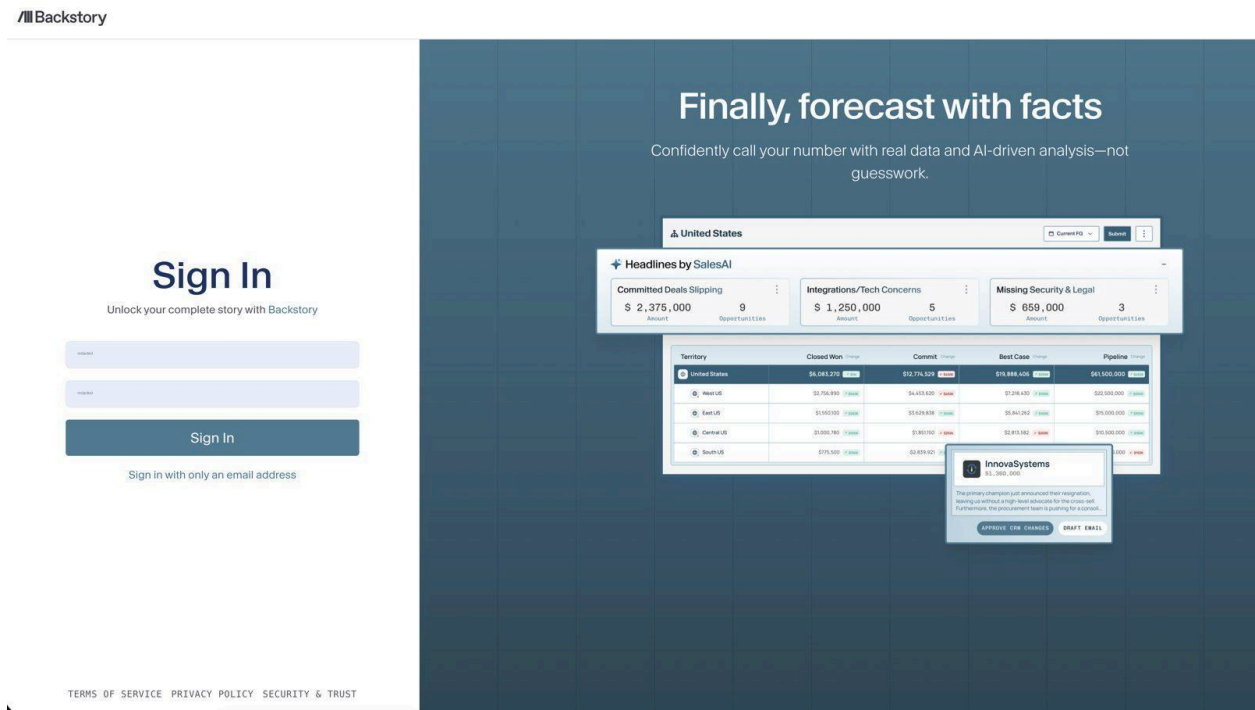
Description	Account, opportunity, activity, engaged-people, and scorecard intelligence from Backstory.
MCP server URL	https://mcp.backstory.ai/mcp
Authentication	OAuth
Trust acknowledgement	Check the box confirming you trust this server

Name it clearly A name like **Backstory MCP** is easy to find in the Plugins menu later.

Watch the URL The path matters: the URL ends in /mcp. A trailing slash or a missing path is the most common reason discovery fails and no tools appear.

5. Sign in to Backstory

ChatGPT opens a Backstory sign-in window. Enter your email and password and select **Sign In**, or use **Sign in with only an email address** to get a link instead. Approve the consent prompt if one appears; the window closes when authentication succeeds and the app shows as connected.

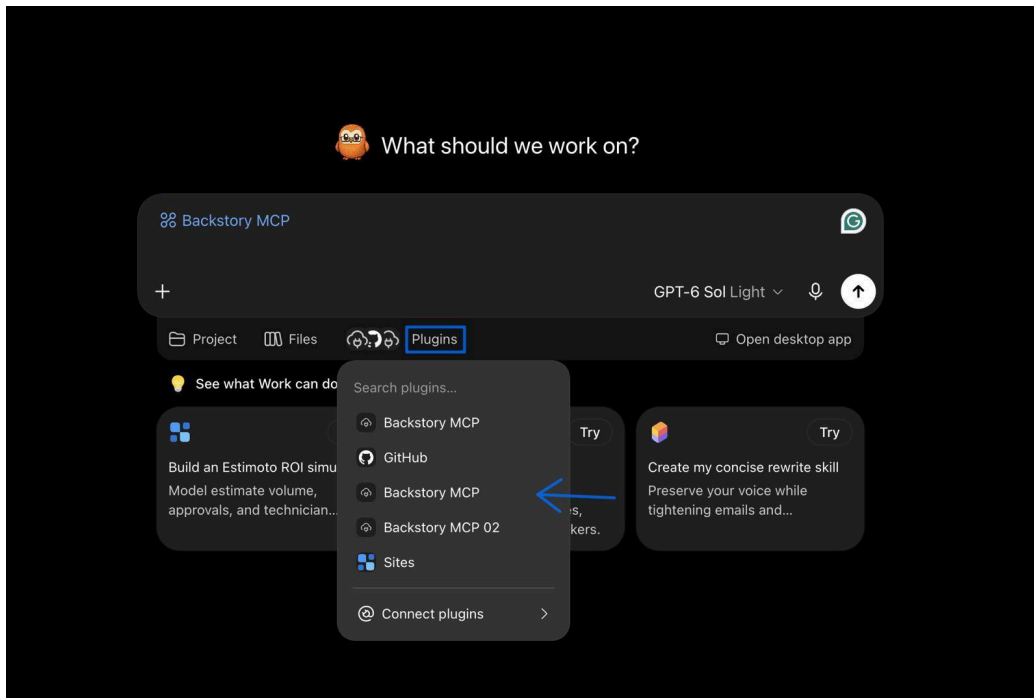


Backstory sign-in — credentials redacted

Popups If nothing happens after Create, the sign-in window was blocked. Allow popups for chatgpt.com and try again.

6. Add Backstory to a chat

Start a new chat and select **Plugins** in the bar under the message box. Pick **Backstory MCP** from the list; it appears as a chip at the top of the composer, which means ChatGPT will call it for this conversation.



Composer → Plugins → Backstory MCP

Several Backstory entries? Pick the one pointed at the environment you want to pull data from. Each entry authenticates separately, so the data you see depends on which one you select.

Verify

The app's tools are discovered automatically — account lookup, account and opportunity status, recent activity, engaged people, scorecards, Situation Search, and the SalesAI questions.

- Ask something that can only come from Backstory, such as **“What’s the current status of [one of your accounts]?”**
- Expand the tool call in the response to confirm ChatGPT called a Backstory tool rather than answering from general knowledge.
- The first call may ask you to confirm the action; approve it, and choose to **always allow** if you don’t want the prompt every time.

Troubleshooting

No Create app option under +. Developer mode is off, or your workspace admin hasn’t allowed custom apps. Recheck Settings → Security and login; on Business or Enterprise, ask an admin.

No tools listed after connecting. Discovery didn’t complete. Check the URL ends in /mcp with no trailing slash, then delete the app and create it again.

Sign-in window never opens. Popups are blocked, or an earlier Backstory session in the same browser is interfering. Allow popups for chatgpt.com, or retry in a private window.

ChatGPT answers without calling Backstory. The app isn’t selected for this chat, or the prompt is too generic. Confirm the Backstory chip is in the composer and name Backstory or a specific account in the question.

Wrong or empty data. Results are scoped to the Backstory user who authenticated. Confirm you picked the right Backstory entry and signed in to the correct environment with the account that owns the records.

Need to reconnect. Open **Plugins** → **Installed**, select the Backstory app, and disconnect. Selecting it again in a chat restarts the sign-in.